RDG-P5 · PRÁCTICA 04

Multiple choice

Hoja 04 · Extracto de novela · dificultad 4 de 4

6 preguntas (31–36) · 2 puntos por pregunta · tiempo orientativo: 18 minutos · sin consultar la teoría

You are going to read an extract from a novel. For questions 31–36, choose the answer (**A, B, C** or **D**) which you think fits best according to the text. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

The Inventory

Daniel had brought labels. Nora saw them as soon as he opened the boot: three rolls of them, in three colours, lying on a stack of flattened cardboard boxes beside a tape gun that still had its price sticker on. Green for keep, he explained, orange for charity, red for the tip. He had worked it all out on the train. Nora, who had been in the house every other day for the past eight months and had not thought to work anything out at all, said that it sounded very sensible.

They began in the front room, because it was the room Daniel remembered best. He moved through it briskly, peeling and pressing, consulting no one. The carriage clock: green. The nest of tables: orange. The armchair, whose cushions still held the shape of their father, he looked at for a moment longer than the rest, and then labelled red without comment. Nora watched him from the doorway. It occurred to her that she had never once seen her brother hesitate over anything, and that she could not be certain she had seen it now.

It was she who had sat in that room through the long evenings of the spring, when their father had mostly slept and occasionally woken to ask whether Daniel had rung. Daniel had rung, as it happened, every Sunday at six, and the calls had lasted between four and seven minutes; Nora knew because she had timed them, though she would not have admitted this to anyone, least of all to herself. Afterwards their father would be in high spirits for an hour or so, and would pass on to her, as if they were news, things she had just heard him being told.

They ate sandwiches standing up in the kitchen, since the chairs had already been labelled. Daniel asked whether the neighbours had been good, and Nora said that they had, in their way, which was true, and that Mrs Ellison next door had brought round a casserole every Thursday, which was not. She was not sure why she had said it. Perhaps she wanted him to know that there had been a whole world here, with its own routines and kindnesses, of which he knew nothing. Perhaps she simply wanted, for once, to be the one with news.

After lunch they moved on to the study. Here Daniel slowed down, not out of sentiment, Nora decided, but because there were so many papers. Their father had kept everything: bank statements going back to the seventies, guarantees for appliances long since thrown away, a letter from the council about a hedge. Daniel started a fourth pile, for shredding, and worked through it with a kind of grim satisfaction, as though each document disposed of were a small argument won. Occasionally he held something up for her inspection – a postcard of Padstow with nothing written on the back, a single cufflink – and she would say keep or go, and he would nod and do as he liked.

It was Nora who found the folder. It had been pushed to the back of the bottom drawer, beneath a road atlas, and it was labelled, in their father's careful capitals, with her name. Inside were her school reports, every one of them from the infant school onwards, and the programme of a play she had been in at fourteen, in which she had had four lines and a hat. There was also a newspaper cutting, so old that it had turned the colour of weak tea, about a prize she had won for an essay on bridges. She had forgotten the prize. She had forgotten, too, that she had ever been interested in bridges.

She did not say anything. After a while Daniel came and looked over her shoulder, and she waited for him to make a joke about the hat. Instead he went back to the desk, opened the drawer above the one she had emptied, and took out a second folder, noticeably thinner than hers, with his own name on it. He did not open it. He laid it on top of hers, squared the edges with his fingertips, and said that perhaps these could go in the car for now, and they could decide about them later.

Nora said that would be fine. She noticed that he had not reached for the labels, and that he did not reach for them again for some time; and she found, somewhat to her own surprise, that she was in no hurry for him to do so.

31 What does the first paragraph suggest about Nora's reply to her brother?

A It expressed real admiration for the trouble he had taken.
B It was a way of disguising how exhausted she felt.
C It masked her feelings about how belatedly he had become involved.
D It showed that she was relieved to let him take charge.

32 What is suggested about Nora's view of her brother in the second paragraph?

A She cannot tell whether he is as unmoved as he seems.
B She admires the speed with which he works.
C She believes he chose that room to avoid more painful ones.
D She thinks he is being careless with valuable objects.

33 The writer mentions that Nora timed her brother's calls in order to

A show that she was more anxious about her father's health than Daniel was.
B reveal feelings about her brother that she preferred not to face.
C suggest that Daniel had kept the calls short out of guilt.
D emphasise how predictable her father's routine had become.

34 What does the writer suggest about Nora's remark concerning Mrs Ellison?

A It was meant to show him how kind the neighbours had been.
B It showed that she had begun to confuse what had really happened.
C It was a calculated attempt to make him feel guilty.
D It reflected a wish to be, for once, the one who knew more.

35 The contents of the folder suggest that

A Nora had been a more gifted child than her brother.
B their father had held on to parts of her life that she herself had let go.
C their father had hoped she would one day become an engineer.
D Nora had been closer to her father as a child than as an adult.

36 What is suggested in the final two paragraphs?

A Daniel is embarrassed that his own folder is thinner than his sister's.
B Nora has decided to leave the remaining decisions to her brother.
C Daniel intends to take both folders home with him.
D The discovery has, for the time being, eased the tension between them.

Hoja de respuestas

Marca una sola letra por pregunta. Al corregir, 2 puntos por acierto; los errores no restan. Anota también el tiempo empleado: el objetivo en el examen son unos 18 minutos.

Nº	A	B	C	D	Puntos
31	A	B	C	D	/ 2
32	A	B	C	D	/ 2
33	A	B	C	D	/ 2
34	A	B	C	D	/ 2
35	A	B	C	D	/ 2
36	A	B	C	D	/ 2
				Total	**/ 12**

Tiempo empleado: _____ minutos.

SOLUCIONES

2 puntos por acierto. Cada solución indica el pasaje, una respuesta propia como la que pide el método (§2.2), por qué la clave es correcta y por qué falla cada distractor, con su tipo (§7) y la cita del texto que lo descarta. Los números de sección remiten a RDG-P5_Teoria_v1.

Clave rápida

Nº	Clave	Tipo de pregunta	Distractores	Teoría
31	**C**	Opinión y actitud	A §7.1 · B §7.7 · D §7.7	§3.3 · §4.3
32	**A**	Opinión y actitud	B §7.1/7.7 · C §7.5 · D §7.7	§3.3 · §6.2
33	**B**	Propósito	A §7.7 · C §7.7 · D §7.1/7.2	§5.1 · §3.3
34	**D**	Implicación	A §7.1/7.2 · B §7.7 · C §7.3	§3.3 · §6.2
35	**B**	Implicación	A §7.5/7.8 · C §7.1/7.7 · D §7.7	§3.3 · §6.2
36	**D**	Implicación	A §7.7 · B §7.3/7.5 · C §7.1/7.7	§3.3 · §3.2

Explicación por pregunta

31 · C · Opinión y actitud

Pregunta: What does the first paragraph suggest about Nora's reply to her brother?

Pasaje: párrafo 1. **Respuesta propia:** Le dice que le parece sensato, pero la frase está cargada: ella lleva meses allí y él llega ahora con un plan.

A It expressed real admiration for the trouble he had taken.
Falla (eco léxico §7.1). Se queda en la letra de said that it sounded very sensible sin atender al contraste que la rodea.

B It was a way of disguising how exhausted she felt.
Falla (ausente §7.7). El texto no habla de cansancio; lo que subraya es el contraste entre every other day for the past eight months y el plan hecho en el tren.

C It masked her feelings about how belatedly he had become involved.
Correcta. La respuesta es cortés, pero el párrafo la encuadra en un contraste: él lo ha resuelto todo en un viaje en tren (He had worked it all out on the train), mientras ella had been in the house every other day for the past eight months. El elogio es understatement (§4.3), y el párrafo 3 confirma el resentimiento (It was she who had sat in that room).

D It showed that she was relieved to let him take charge.
Falla (ausente §7.7). Nada indica alivio. Daniel decide solo (consulting no one), y el resto del extracto muestra que eso no le resulta indiferente.

Teoría: §3.3 Narradores y personajes · §4.3 Ironía, understatement y concesión

32 · A · Opinión y actitud

Pregunta: What is suggested about Nora's view of her brother in the second paragraph?

Pasaje: párrafo 2. **Respuesta propia:** No sabe si de verdad no siente nada o si lo disimula.

A She cannot tell whether he is as unmoved as he seems.
Correcta. Daniel mira el sillón for a moment longer than the rest, y Nora no sabe interpretarlo: she could not be certain she had seen it now. Duda de si su hermano, que nunca vacila, ha vacilado esta vez, es decir, de si su frialdad es real.

B She admires the speed with which he works.
Falla (eco léxico §7.1, ausente §7.7). He moved through it briskly describe su ritmo, pero nada en el párrafo sugiere admiración.

C She believes he chose that room to avoid more painful ones.
Falla (lógica §7.5). El texto da otro motivo: empiezan por esa habitación because it was the room Daniel remembered best.

D She thinks he is being careless with valuable objects.
Falla (ausente §7.7). El texto no valora cómo trata Daniel los objetos; la única duda de Nora tiene que ver con lo que él siente (she had never once seen her brother hesitate over anything).

Teoría: §3.3 Narradores y personajes · §6.2 Lo concreto del texto, lo abstracto de la opción

33 · B · Propósito

Pregunta: The writer mentions that Nora timed her brother's calls in order to

Pasaje: párrafo 3. **Respuesta propia:** Para mostrar que tenía celos de lo que esas llamadas significaban para su padre, aunque no quisiera reconocerlo.

A show that she was more anxious about her father's health than Daniel was.
Falla (ausente §7.7). Las llamadas no se relacionan con la salud del padre, sino con el efecto que tenían en él (in high spirits).

B reveal feelings about her brother that she preferred not to face.
Correcta. El dato dice más de Nora que de Daniel: lo hacía though she would not have admitted this to anyone, least of all to herself. Y el contexto explica el porqué: tras cada llamada el padre estaba in high spirits for an hour or so y le contaba a ella lo que acababa de oír. Es una voz narradora que sabe más que el personaje (§3.3).

C suggest that Daniel had kept the calls short out of guilt.
Falla (ausente §7.7). El texto da la duración (between four and seven minutes), pero no la explica ni atribuye a Daniel ningún sentimiento.

D emphasise how predictable her father's routine had become.
Falla (eco léxico §7.1, no responde §7.2). El dato every Sunday at six habla de la regularidad de Daniel, no de la rutina del padre; y cronometrar las llamadas dice algo de Nora, no de él.

Teoría: §5.1 Para qué sirve un fragmento · §3.3 Narradores y personajes

34 · D · Implicación

Pregunta: What does the writer suggest about Nora's remark concerning Mrs Ellison?

Pasaje: párrafo 4. **Respuesta propia:** Que se lo inventa para tener, por una vez, algo que él no sabe.

A It was meant to show him how kind the neighbours had been.
Falla (eco léxico §7.1, no responde §7.2). Es lo que dice, pero el narrador aclara que lo de la cazuela no era cierto (which was not): el motivo no puede ser elogiar a los vecinos.

B It showed that she had begun to confuse what had really happened.
Falla (ausente §7.7). Nora sabe que es falso; lo que no sabe es por qué lo ha dicho (She was not sure why she had said it).

C It was a calculated attempt to make him feel guilty.
Falla (alcance §7.3). Calculated choca con She was not sure why she had said it, y el texto no habla de culpa.

D It reflected a wish to be, for once, the one who knew more.
Correcta. El narrador da dos posibles motivos y los dos apuntan a lo mismo: que Daniel supiera que había un mundo of which he knew nothing, o to be the one with news. Este último eco remite al párrafo 3, donde era el padre quien le daba a ella las noticias de Daniel.

Teoría: §3.3 Narradores y personajes · §6.2 Lo concreto del texto, lo abstracto de la opción

35 · B · Implicación

Pregunta: The contents of the folder suggest that

Pasaje: párrafo 6. **Respuesta propia:** Que el padre había guardado cosas de ella que ella misma había olvidado.

A Nora had been a more gifted child than her brother.
Falla (lógica §7.5, pasaje vecino §7.8). La carpeta de Daniel es más delgada (noticeably thinner than hers), pero eso dice algo de lo que guardó el padre, no del talento de cada uno.

B their father had held on to parts of her life that she herself had let go.
Correcta. El padre guardó every one of them from the infant school onwards, y el párrafo termina con dos olvidos de Nora: She had forgotten the prize y She had forgotten, too, that she had ever been interested in bridges. El contraste entre lo que él conservó y lo que ella perdió es el sentido del hallazgo.

C their father had hoped she would one day become an engineer.
Falla (eco léxico §7.1, ausente §7.7). Sale de an essay on bridges; el texto no dice nada de lo que el padre esperaba de ella.

D Nora had been closer to her father as a child than as an adult.
Falla (ausente §7.7). El texto no compara épocas de la relación; la carpeta documenta la infancia y la adolescencia (at fourteen), sin decir nada de cómo cambió el trato.

Teoría: §3.3 Narradores y personajes · §6.2 Lo concreto del texto, lo abstracto de la opción

36 · D · Implicación

Pregunta: What is suggested in the final two paragraphs?

Pasaje: párrafos 7 y 8. **Respuesta propia:** Que el hallazgo los acerca: él deja su sistema de etiquetas y a ella no le importa esperar.

A Daniel is embarrassed that his own folder is thinner than his sister's.
Falla (ausente §7.7). El texto registra el dato (noticeably thinner than hers), pero no atribuye a Daniel ningún sentimiento; su gesto es cuidadoso, no avergonzado.

B Nora has decided to leave the remaining decisions to her brother.
Falla (alcance §7.3, lógica §7.5). La frase she was in no hurry for him to do so se refiere a las etiquetas: no quiere que él vuelva a su sistema, no que decida por ella. Y Daniel propone decidir juntos (they could decide about them later).

C Daniel intends to take both folders home with him.
Falla (eco léxico §7.1, ausente §7.7). La propuesta de que las carpetas vayan al coche (go in the car for now) es provisional: Daniel aplaza la decisión, no la toma.

D The discovery has, for the time being, eased the tension between them.
Correcta. Daniel, que nunca vacila, aparca su sistema: He did not open it, junta las carpetas con cuidado (squared the edges with his fingertips) y aplaza la decisión. Nora, que había recibido las etiquetas con resentimiento, ya no tiene prisa: she was in no hurry for him to do so. For the time being recoge el for some time del texto: es una tregua, no una reconciliación cerrada.

Teoría: §3.3 Narradores y personajes · §3.2 De dónde sale una inferencia